

Whistleblower Protection Policy

The Whistleblower Protection Policy is designed to safeguard employees who report concerns or wrongdoing within the organization, ensuring that they can do so without fear of retaliation. As described under the IT Change Management Procedure, all reports made through our third-party ethics hotline will be treated as confidential and anonymous, allowing individuals to come forward without revealing their identity. This provision is in line with the Acceptable Use of Company Technology Policy, which explicitly prohibits the use of company technology for personal or malicious purposes, including retaliation against whistleblowers.

Retaliation against an employee who reports wrongdoing or makes a good-faith report will be grounds for immediate termination, as stated under the Employee Conduct and Termination Policy. This policy is designed to protect employees from reprisals, ensuring that they can speak up without fear of losing their job or facing other adverse consequences. The Whistleblower Protection Policy is an integral part of our commitment to maintaining a safe and respectful work environment.

In the event of a report being made through the ethics hotline, the reporting individual will be protected from retaliation under this policy. This protection extends not only to the reporter but also to any witnesses or individuals who may have provided supporting information. As described under the Employee Conduct and Termination Policy, any employee found to have retaliated against a whistleblower will face severe disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

The Whistleblower Protection Policy is an essential component of our organization's commitment to ethics and compliance. By providing a safe and confidential reporting mechanism, we aim to encourage employees to speak up when they witness wrongdoing or unethical behavior. This policy is designed to promote transparency, accountability, and trust within the organization, and we are committed to upholding its principles in all aspects of our operations.